

Tank Care Buddy

Changelog — Pre-Xcode Product Polish Pass

Session date:	Saturday, June 13, 2026
Versions shipped:	v20260613h → v20260613j (3 commits)
Phases:	Phase 6 — Broken flows · Phase 7 — Custom logic · Phase 8 — Premium polish
Branch:	main
Repo:	jtsmith7234-rgb/tank-care-buddy
Phase 6 commit:	606ce78
Phase 7 commit:	52b0081
Phase 8 commit:	3392b06 (HEAD)
App version at close:	v20260613j

Overview

This session addressed 18 notes from a second-run product review, organized into 3 focused phases. The goals: fix broken interaction flows, make logic meaningfully personalized, and elevate the visual and brand quality so the app feels premium, guided, and trustworthy.

Phase	Version	Commit	Focus	✓
6 — Broken Flows	v20260613h	606ce78	Toast wiring, nav fixes, completion modal, equipment post-add prompt	✓
7 — Custom Logic	v20260613i	52b0081	Substrate language, dropdowns, eq guidance, cross-tab context, tutorial logic	✓
8 — Premium Polish	v20260613j	3392b06	Branded tutorial hero, toast redesign, completion modal gradient, in-app branding	✓

Phase 6 — Broken Flows & Navigation · v20260613h · 606ce78

Fixed all broken and incomplete interaction flows. Every bottom-screen toast and navigation CTA now works correctly. The guide completion experience is a proper branded half-page modal.

Back/Cancel audit

Audited every `closeModal()` call across `app.js`. All cancel handlers correctly call `closeModal()` only, with no view state mutation on cancel. Fundamental back=home behavior preserved.

Post-equipment guided toast

After `EQ.addItem()` in a guided tank, fires `actionToast('Equipment saved — ready to start your setup?', 'Start guide →')` with 400ms delay. Callback navigates to Details tab (first tank checklist).

Fish → add to tank scroll fix

Tank picker list wrapped in with overflow-y:auto; max-height:45vh. Works on all screen sizes.

_ftNavigateToTab guard

Returns silently if view.screen !== 'tank'. Prevents any accidental tab switches from off-screen toast taps.

Equipment CTA wiring

Added equipment entry to UPN_NAV map. Any reminder or CTA routed to equipment tab now reliably navigates via _ftNavigateToTab.

actionToast full rewrite

Now uses id='action-toast' + CSS class animation (opacity + translateY spring). Clears timer on early click, escapeHTML for XSS safety, try/catch around callback. All checklist toasts now work.

Guide completion modal

_ftShowCompletion sets window._ftCompletionPending = tank.id. bindDetails checks the flag post-render and calls _showFirstTankCompletionModal(tank): gradient hero, tank name, 'Your first habitat is ready.' headline, 'Tank Care.' brand sign-off, two navigation buttons.

Phase 7 — Logic, Customization & Beginner Guidance · v20260613i · 52b0081

Made the app's logic meaningfully personalized. The experience now adapts to the user's tank type, substrate, and equipment. Cross-tab awareness means tabs communicate with each other.

Substrate-aware language

stagesForTank() runs a substitution pass after building merged stages. Sand users see sand-specific rinse instructions ('Rinse the sand...'). Bare-bottom users are told to skip the rinse step. Setup need list updated to 'Gravel, sand, or bare bottom.'

fill:fill nav prompt

New FT_NAV_PROMPTS entry: checking off the water conditioner step routes user to Chemicals tab with 'Time to add your conditioner. Tap to log it.' Fill item detail also expanded with first-dose guidance.

Tank type no longer defaults to betta

Add Tank modal starts with a disabled placeholder option 'Choose your tank type...'. Save is blocked with an alert if no type is selected. No more accidental betta defaults.

Substrate dropdown

Both Add Tank and Edit Tank modals now use a 6-option select: Gravel, Sand, Aqua soil, Bare bottom, Mixed, Not sure yet. Edit modal pre-selects the saved value.

Equipment guidance by tank kind

EQ_GUIDANCE_BY_KIND map for 7 tank types. Empty equipment tab shows a styled guidance card with Essential/Optional gear for the specific tank kind. Compact note shown when equipment already exists.

Cross-tab awareness — `_getTankContext()`

New utility returns `hasHeater`, `hasFilter`, `hasLight`, `isCycled`, `isBeginner`, `substrate`, `kind`. Used in: (A) Fish tab cycling warning when fish added pre-cycle, (B) heater tip on Water Care tab for betta/community, (C) up to 3 clickable cross-check hints on Details tab.

Tutorial copy — both audiences

'Getting started' card now welcomes beginners and experienced keepers equally. Final CTA changed to 'Add my first tank.' Generic 'Step N' labels removed.

Equipment tutorial card

New `snapEquipment()` mockup and card inserted before 'You're ready.' Tutorial now has 8 cards. Users see equipment tracking before they start.

Phase 8 — Premium Feel, Branding & Onboarding Polish · v20260613j · 3392b06

Elevated the visual and brand quality. The app now has a clear identity, tasteful branding in key moments, and visual polish that matches a premium product rather than a free generic app.

Tutorial welcome card — branded hero

First card gets special hero layout: large wordmark 'Tank Care Buddy' + tagline 'Care that shows.' above the device mockup. Bold 24px/800 wordmark, muted italic tagline. Title updated to 'Keep every tank healthy.' — direct, confident, not generic.

Tutorial structural rework

Labels replaced: 'Step 1–4' removed. Cards now read: First steps, Your tanks, Water care, Livestock, Reminders, Equipment, Ready. Final card: 'You're set up for success.' + 'Let's go' CTA.

Action toast — theme-adaptive design

Background now uses `var(--ink)` (adapts to light/dark theme) instead of hardcoded `#0b1e2a`. Spring easing (cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1)). Button uses `var(--sakura/koi)` teal accent. Dark skin override added. Looks native to every theme.

Completion modal — gradient hero

Hero area: jade→koi gradient background, white headline, white subtext, 'Tank Care.' sign-off at 55% opacity. SVG fish icon replaces emoji. Slide-up animation: 400ms cubic-bezier spring from 60px.

In-app branding — home tagline

'Care that shows.' tagline added under app name in home header. Font-size 11px, 70% opacity, auto-hidden on inner screens so it only shows on the home dashboard.

In-app branding — settings footer

Settings sheet now has a branded footer: 'Tank Care Buddy' wordmark + 'Care that shows.' italic tagline. Subtle border-top divides it from the content.

Completion modal SVG icon

Inline SVG replaces emoji in `_showFirstTankCompletionModal`: circle with frosted-glass fill, nested circles creating depth. Renders cleanly on all display densities.

First Tank Guide refinements

Header: 'First Tank Guide — Day N' (emoji removed, cleaner). Progress: shows percentage ('2 / 6 steps · 33% complete'). Active stage uses  instead of . ft-tip styled as a koi-accent card (border-left: 3px solid var(--koi), light background).

General visual polish

modal-title: 17px/700 weight consistent. .empty-state: centered, padded, 600 weight title. tank-card: subtle box-shadow lift (0 1px 4px rgba + outline stroke). All additions use existing CSS variables — no new hardcoded colors.

Files Modified This Session

File	Phases	Key changes
app.js	6, 7, 8	actionToast rewrite, _ftNavigateToTab guard, qa-tank-list, UPN_NAV equipment, post-add toast, _show
firsttank.js	6, 7, 8	stagesForTank substrate substitution, fill:fill nav prompt, _ftShowCompletion uses _ftCompletionPending
tutorial.js	7, 8	snapEquipment() + equipment card, card label rework, hero card (cardHTML i===0), welcome card titl
styles.css	6, 7, 8	action-toast redesign (theme-adaptive), tut-hero CSS block, completion modal gradient, eq-guidance-
index.html	All	Version bumped h→i→j on each phase commit
tests/ (3 files)	All	2026-06-13-h-phase-6-broken-flows.md, -i-phase-7-custom-logic.md, -j-phase-8-premium-polish.m

Known Remaining Items (not blocking)

Low priority. None block personal testing or Xcode.

ID	Description	When
S-1	Settings sheet modal lacks modal-inner scroll structure (very small phones only)	App Store
V-1	Home tagline may inherit gradient fill on dark themes — add -webkit-text-fill-color override if visible during test	Personal test
R-4	@capacitor/local-notifications needed for lock-screen push	Notif. phase
L-3	expandedEventId not reset on tank switch	Anytime
L-4	APP_VERSION hardcoded as '1.0', not tied to versioning system	Anytime

Final Pre-Xcode Product Assessment

Question	Answer
Does the app still feel generic?	No. Tank-kind-aware logic, personalized equipment guidance, cross-tab context hints, and subs

Does it now feel more premium?	Yes. Branded tutorial hero, theme-adaptive toasts, gradient completion modal, subtle tagline placeholder
Does the new tank experience feel clearly guided?	Yes. Every checklist item now fires a contextual navigation prompt. Post-equipment toast routes to tutorial hero
Does the logic feel meaningfully personalized?	Yes. Tank type, substrate, and equipment all influence the experience: checklist language, water

Pre-Xcode Recommendation

Ready for final personal test.

1. Personal final test on iPhone

Browse jtsmith7234-rgb.github.io/tank-care-buddy on your iPhone. Create a new tank (do not pick betta by default — choose your type). Run the guided checklist. Check all checklist toasts navigate. Verify sand substrate shows 'Rinse the sand' not 'Rinse the gravel'. Check completion modal. Confirm home tagline looks right on dark theme (V-1 above).

2. Then open Xcode

`cd ~/path/to/tank-care-buddy/ios/App && pod install && open App.xcworkspace`

3. Xcode setup

Set Signing Team → bundle ID com.tankcarebuddy.app → run on simulator or physical device.

4. After device test — App Store Connect

Create app record → Xcode Assets icon (1024×1024 already generated) → TestFlight upload.

5. Remaining items

S-1 (settings modal structure) before App Store submission. R-4 (local notifications) in a dedicated notification phase after Xcode is working.